



YOU SAID IT



Nothing beats the print version of the magazine!

I recently read the article 'Is Your Home Clouded?' in the *LINUX For You* January 2011 issue. I know that was almost a year-and-a-half ago but it was a good and enlightening read. Being the son of a publisher, I can tell you that books (of the paper variety) have their own value and can't be replaced by their e-versions. Though I am a tech enthusiast, I still spend hours reading a paperback rather than strain my eyes on the laptop screen.

I agree with the author that some great friendships have begun by sharing books. In my case, it's the bonding between my sister and me.

Both of us are avid readers and like books from different genres. So whenever I come across a good book, I make sure that she reads it and she does the same. We even have our own little library in which we have stored all the books that we read through our childhood and we share them with our cousins and friends. It's the ultimate experience – and something that cannot be had by switching to the digital versions of books.

I look forward to reading more of your articles.

—Uday Mittal,
mittal.ud@gmail.com

ED: It's great to hear from readers about older issues too! We shall certainly convey your words of appreciation to the author of the article, Niyam Bhushan.

We appreciate your sentiments regarding preferring the hard copy of the magazines to their e-versions. True, reading articles on the computer screen, online, doesn't have quite the same charm as savouring every word printed on 'papyrus'. However, the ezine version has its own set of advantages that we can't ignore either!



Open source decoded poetically

I am a great technology enthusiast. Programming is not only my hobby but my passion. I like to read up on a variety of topics related to technology, especially on open source. I have been reading your magazine since last year, and I found it very informative and rich in content. At the beginning of every month, I look forward to laying my hands on the latest issue of *LFY*. Along with programming, writing poems is my other hobby, though my poems are of different genres. Here's a sample...

Frisky Life

Deep down in a sector of a hard disk
Lies a piece of code called Frisk
It has been there for some time
Waiting to be executed any time
Sitting in its lonely sector
It now reminisces about the time
When it wasn't even a line.

Eureka! What an idea for the SE project.

I will create software that will detect a potential threat

That was the day Frisk was conceived.

With a bright future it seemed.

What SE model should I follow to develop Frisk?

Spiral, Waterfall, RAD or one of my own tricks?

Wait! Oh wait! There's a stage left,

Use case, DFD, UML and SRS haven't been made yet,

Frisk aced through every stage but what came next was a critical phase.

It's time to decide the architecture for Frisk.

A wrong choice will be a catastrophic risk.

n-Tiered, Client-Server, Blackboard, Structured, etc.

Made the selection a tough task and there's no one I could ask.

After much deliberation and thought, Frisk's future was plot.

With everything in place, Frisk entered the development phase

Being a Windows' citizen .Net was the proven choice.

I developed it piece by piece to avoid a mess of files.

Having done with pieces I compiled them into modules

And saved it from becoming a programmer's ridicule.

With few days left for delivery, Frisk moved to the next stage.

A threefold stage of Assembly, Compilation and Execution came.

Assembly of modules gave a prototype that was then set to compile.

After bug elimination and successful execution, I gave a smile.

I named this version as Alpha, later ones being called Beta and Gamma.

The end of this stage was a relief but will the final stage

turn it into grief?

The next stage was every software's worst nightmare.

As it involved putting it through a series of tests that scare.

Frisk too was to be put to multiple tests;

Black Box, White Box, and Stress tests were only some of them.

It faced every test with strength and courage

And matured into a better software package.

Alas! The time came and Frisk was unveiled.

It bagged lots of praise and I felt great.

Sitting in its lonely sector,

It now smiles as it reminisces about those old times

When it became much more than a line.

You can find more of my poems at <http://genemesis.wordpress.com>.

This is a blog I run to post my poems whenever I get time to write.

Hope you like all of them.

—Uday Mittal,
mittal.ud@gmail.com